



New Jersey State Governor's Volunteerism Awards

Celebrating 2026 VOLUNTEERS

We salute New Jersey's Volunteers and applaud their exemplary service.

AMBASSADOR

Alina Parikh
Avika Shukla
Pranav Soleti
Priyana Manglani

ANIMAL WELFARE

Aidan Gershengoren
Claire Cheng
Edward C. Sullivan

ARTS AND CULTURE

Aarav Gupta
Adelaide Macri
Ava Silva Costa
Eunice Cho
Gina Priano-Keyser
Scarlett Oh
Shaan Dave
Yashvi Rateshwar
Yassine Ait Ali

COMMUNITY PILLAR

Kathleen Lekko
Tasha Youngblood Brown

COMMUNITY PILLAR(YOUTH)

Advay Shukla
Akshaya Sureshkumar
Elizabeth Wang
Isabella Tomeo
Neel Sood
Sameer Sood
Siddhant Chopdar
Vincent Zeferino
Warren Sanuhath Pinnawalage
Yashvi Bharariya

DR. MARTIN LUTHER KING JR. CHAMPION FOR JUSTICE

Kay LiCausi
Naa'san S.J. Carr
Ryan Bates
Sara Osman

EDUCATION

Ajay Tolia
Diane Somers
Evva Vassiliou
**HTCS Business Exploration
Workshop**
Lauren Horner-Bell

EMERGENCY SERVICES/ FIRST RESPONDERS

Carmine Steffens
Dia Avalur
Col. Scott L(awrence) Pileckas
Sharika Dhar
Simonee Shukla

ENVIRONMENTAL STEWARDSHIP

Dhruv Maini
Keep New Jersey Clean
Matthew Kwon
**Monmouth County Park System
Volunteers In Parks**
Suma Evany

FAITH-BASED SERVICES

Elaine Graham Francis
Help and Hope Ministries
Morgan Harkness
Noel Yoo

FEED THE HUNGRY

Anakh Sawhney
Ben Cha
Esha Desai
Hunters Helping the Hungry
Magdalen Costello
Michael Caruso

FOUNDERS/INNOVATORS

Dana Maier
Dvora Inwood
Kaitlyn Klaus
Kavin Arora
Mattie Krause
Rishi Vamdatt

GOOD NEIGHBOR

John V. Kelly III
Kathryn Distler
Lisa Burd - Project Be A Hero
Radhika Parkash
Vera Venkata Rahini Bachu

HEALTH CARE SERVICE

Achyut Nuli
Armaan Balani
Ashley Levinson
Dharmaraj Nagarajan
Inaaya Siddiqi
Jeuel Cato
Melania D. Urbina
Women's Association for
Morristown Medical Center
[WAMMC]

HOUSE AND HOME

Claribel Ramirez
Cuts 4 Unique Minds, Inc
Martin Slezak
Student Leadership Board
Covenant House New Jersey

*Names in bold indicate
medallists.*

NJ NATIONAL SERVICE PROGRAMS

Audrey Zudick
Jacqueline Powell-Wicks
John May
John Rice
Maxine Wilensky
Michael Wellons
William P Hamilton

SERVICE THROUGH STEM

Arjun Tiwari
Ashritha Nayanala
Kavita Yadav
Khushi Khurana
Sarvesh Anand
Shaoyu Yuan
William Rosenthal

SERVICE TO YOUTH

Dhara Ashar
Imagine's Volunteer Facilitators
Louisa Ho
Nate Jackson
Zeryoon Ibraiz

VOLUNTEER LEADERSHIP

Arron Rustici
Laura Dickinson
Patricia Carlesimo

VOLUNTEER LEADERSHIP (YOUTH)

Advik Rao Yennaamaneni
Aily Wei
Bianca Scalzo
Dhavan Narne
Diya Chandarana
Nandita Dani
Naya Shah
Saida Ibrayeva

VOLUNTEER PROGRAM/GROUP

Alpha XI Omega Alumni
Chapter of Iota Phi Theta
Fraternity Inc.
Greenhorn Innovation Fund
NJ Mental Health Players
(NJMHP)
The Period Equity Project
Zooming Thru Music

VOLUNTEER PROGRAM/ GROUP(YOUTH)

**Greater Princeton Alliance of
Youth Leaders (GPA)**
Project Senior CARE
Holmdel/Monmouth County
Chapter of Thrive2gethr

Program Administered By:



NJ Governor's
Office of Volunteerism



WATCH THE CEREMONY LIVE
Sunday, September 27, 2026

<https://www.youtube.com/live/yocGvy6STIY>

Program Sponsor:

